

Vertigo



(Surf's up on Te ao Whakere! photo by Simon Williamson)

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club - Wellington Section
www.facebook.com/nzacwellington Twitter @NZACWellington

Section News

Section Nights

We skipped section night in June – pretty sure most people were more than happy to wander along to see the BANFF films instead. Hopefully all those who wanted to get to the BANFF screenings managed to get tickets. As always these were super-popular with both section members and members of the public resulting in all sessions being sold out.

In July we have our section night on Wednesday 6 July at the Southern Cross where we have a presentation on yoga and functional movement in the context of climbing. I'm sure many of us could do with some ideas on how to keep limber and strong for climbing so come along to find out more.

Also in July we have Aviette talking on avalanche awareness on **Tuesday 19 July** – this is timely for those intending on heading into the mountains over the next few months. Come and learn about avalanche safety and, more importantly, avoidance. This talk will be in our usual spot at the Southern Cross.

Remember our section nights are open to people outside of the section so bring along friends and family who are interested.

Chair's Report

A big thanks to Aviette for another outstanding Banff! Yep, its already been and gone along with the shortest day of the year. Four sell out sessions. I think my favourite was Paddle for the North, especially because we had the director Simon Lucas there to introduce the film. I also thought the ad for Nature Rx was excellent. Pharmac should it add it to their list so more people can afford it. Thanks to all of you who bought tickets. This is currently our only fund raiser. The funds help to bring in some of the section night speakers and subsidise some of the climbing trips as well as maintain and replace gear for courses. If you have any comments on what you liked or didn't like send us a tweet [@NZACWellington] or post a message on our Facebook page [www.facebook.com/nzacwellington]. We are seriously considering hosting six sessions next year with possibly a third selection of films. Would you go to three selections? Gina and Elisha are also in the throes of arranging to host ReelRock later this year. So for all you stone monkeys and for those who like to watch stone monkeys at work, watch this space for when and where.

On the trip front, six of us had an awesome trip to the seaward Kaikoura range over Queens Birthday, which you can read about later in this edition. Some of the photos are on our Facebook page.

The July section night focuses on how to bend over backwards to get up a mountain. Not a yoga class so no need to bring your mat. The annual section photo comp is also underway. Elisha is busy gathering up prizes for the category winners. More details later in this edition.

Coming down Willis Street today I saw Earth Sea Sky has a popup shop – next door to the Bivouac outlet. No money was received for product placements in this film but these guys do have some awesome kit. Worth a look if you have some coin to part with.

Normally I would promote our winter courses but they are already fully booked for the year. Aviette will be running our annual avalanche awareness seminar at the Southern Cross on Tuesday 19th July (note this is in addition to our section night on the 6th). Mark Leslie is also organising a four day avalanche course. Details for that are yet to be confirmed. Otherwise there is the ice climbing meet at Tukino on the 9th and 10th of July which Eric is organising. If you have any ideas for trips and or would like to lead one, email the committee at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Happy climbing and don't forget to write up your winter trips and send them in for your moment of fame.

Simon

Chair: NZAC Wellington

For quick access to the section's page on the NZAC website, scan the below QR code.



Upcoming Trips, Courses and Events

Wellington Section Trips

The enthusiasm of several section members has been piqued by the successful section outing to Te Ao Whekere over Queen's Birthday weekend (see the write up on this trip later in Vertigo).

Ian Barnes has indicated he is keen to get a trip scheduled for 8-9 October with a preference for something in the top half of the South Island. Tapuae-o-Uenuku is a possibility but he's open to suggestions. Rental vehicle costs would be covered by the section so please contact Ian on ianbarnes@me.com if you're interested and to get in your vote for a destination. late September

We're also considering a section trip to climb Mt Aspiring in November. There will likely be a limit on numbers for this trip, and skill and fitness level criteria to meet.

Keep an eye on our Facebook page for more details or email us on wellington@alpineclub.org.nz to let us know if you're keen to come along. Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the committee can help with advertising / logistics.

When?	Where?
8-9 October	Tapuae-o-Uenuku / other top of the South Island destination
November	Mt Aspiring



Mt Aspiring

NZAC North Island Ice-climbing meet

Location: TASC Lodge, Tukino Ski Field, Mt Ruapehu

Date: Weekend of July 8 - 10, 2016



© Iain Burgon

Cost: \$89 for the weekend (this covers accommodation, breakfast and lunch on Saturday and Sunday, and Saturday night's dinner)

This is a climbing meet so you are expected to organise your own climbing partners and transport to TASC lodge (4WD plus snow chains required!).

Register online at <https://tukino.checkfront.com/reserve/> - click on NZAC Events at Tukino.

Contact Eric Duggan (021 350 161) or ericduggan@gmail.com for more information.

See <http://climbnz.org.nz/nz/ni/tongariro/mt-ruapehu/tukino> for information about climbs.



© Iain Burgon

Wellington Section Photo Competition 2016



Categories:

Alpine Activity: climbing, skiing, whatever you do up high

Photographs where the main subject is people engaging in activity in the alpine environment (e.g. climbing, skiing, tramping, camping). Emphasis on careful composition and 'capturing the moment'.

Alpine General: scenery and views that make you want to come back

Photographs that display mountain landscapes. Images should be strongly composed with great light. Judges will be weighing technical excellence, colour, tone and detail along with the image's subject and composition.

Alpine Nature: the little gems of beauty along the way

Photographs of natural subjects in the mountain environment, where the emphasis is on artistic rendition. Subjects may include geological features, plants (or parts of plants), animals, water, snow and ice formations etc.

Rock climbing: hardest moves, slickest lines

Photographs of rock climbing and bouldering that have strong visual impact and creative composition.

Mountain and Climbing Culture: climbing life, places and people

Portray the climbing life and places and people encountered by climbers. Entries might include travel photography (as long as it's strongly related to climbing) or documentary-style images, covering any aspect of climbing.

Humour: whatever gets you a laugh

Kids photos

Alpine / climbing-related photos taken by kids aged 6 to 14 (please include age of the child when submitting entries in this category)

Judging criteria:

1. Category relevance – is the shot on subject, or should it be in a different category
2. Technical competence/excellence – is the shot exposed well – right balance of dark and light, no burn out. Is depth of field used well/is the shot appropriately focused
3. Creativity – what is different about the shot. Does an idea/story come through in the shot. Does it draw the viewer in/have emotional impact. What makes it more than just a pretty snap - unusual angle, choice of exposure settings, inclusion (or exclusion) of person or object to give context
4. Difficulty to shoot – dawn/dusk, challenging light, difficult to reach angle

1 and 2 are essential just to be accepted in category. 3 is what will define a winner, unless there are 2 winners, in which case 4, while not essential, might be the decider. Prizes will be awarded to the best photo in each category.

Image Specifications:

The closing date for the competition is the 8 August and the winners will be announced at the section night on Wednesday 7 September.

Entries should be sent to peter.laurenson@clear.net.nz

For each photo you need to supply a caption, the category, say who the photographer is and where and when the photo was taken.

All images must have been taken by the competitor and be his or her property, but need not have been processed by him or her.

Images need not necessarily have been taken in New Zealand.

Entries are permitted in digital format only. Files must be JPEG format between 500KB and 3MB (at least 2000 pixels on the long side) will be accepted.

Digital processing should be mostly restricted to dust removal, cropping, resizing, global exposure and tonal adjustments. HDR, and exposure, focus or sequence blending are permitted. Cloning or removing parts of an image (except in the case of the above) are not permitted. Obvious modification of images is not in keeping with the objectives of this competition and may result in disqualification.

Images not meeting these specifications will not be judged.

Please ensure you have permission from people in your photos that their image can be used and possibly published in Vertigo.

Judges

Peter Laurenson – photographer profile

Since leaving New Zealand for his OE in 1988, Peter and his camera have been drawn to many mountain places, in particular in Nepal, India, Pakistan and Tibet; and back home in New Zealand's beautiful high country; but to a few other interesting places too. From hiking and trekking beginnings he joined the NZAC in 2002 and has since become an occasional climber. Since 2004 he has won several Wellington Section and National NZAC annual photo competition awards, including the Overall winner (John Harrison memorial trophy) in 2014. To mark turning 50, in 2012 he climbed Aoraki Mount Cook with Guide Gary Dickson and then published a photographic book, Occasional Climber – a journey to Mount Clarity. He has since built a website www.occasionalclimber.co.nz, where you can view his thousands of images (presented in region and route-based slideshows) and order a copy of the book (43 copies left) if so inclined.

Nigel Roberts – photographer profile

Nigel Roberts has been taking photographs of mountains for more than fifty years. He first had climbing photographs published in David Dodds' book, A Cradle of Rivers: The Natal Drakenberg, in 1975. In 1979-80 he was New Zealand's Information Officer / Photographer in Antarctica, and while there he took his most famous photograph – of the koru symbol and tail of the Air New Zealand DC-10 that crashed on Mt Erebus. Like Peter Laurenson, Nigel also has a website, and a range of his climbing and other pictures can be seen on it (www.nigel-roberts.info). Last year Nigel Roberts had a photograph published in The Guardian Weekly (but it wasn't of a mountain – it was of Prince Harry during his visit to New Zealand).

Trip Reports

A weekend fit for a queen

Scott Wotring

Despite the record breaking sunshine hours in the first part of 2016, our third nominated weekend

The Wellington section of the Alpine Club summited Te ao Whekere in the Seaward Kaikouras over the Queen's Birthday weekend in spectacular fashion.

At 2590 metres, Te ao Whekere (the world of the gods) is the second tallest peak in the range. Following a cold snap, the mountains wore a fresh coat of snow, providing just enough cover to scamper across the scree slopes and pigeon hole our way up onto the summit ridge to complete a first class alpine adventure.

Simon from Wellington section led the trip and was joined by Carolyn, Leo and myself from Wellington, and Summer and Matt from the Christchurch section. After a smooth sailing we picked up a hire car and headed for Puhi Puhi campsite. The clear, cold night provided a hint of what to expect at 2000m. We jumped straight in our bags after arriving at 11pm.



The view of our destination from Puhi Peaks Station

In the morning, following a crash course in transceivers from Simon, we drove 30 minutes to the road-end and met another Matt, operations manager for Kaikoura Wilderness Experience and Puhi Peaks Station. Matt was exceptionally helpful, providing guidance and leading us across the property and onto the route up Happy Valley. During the summer months the property owner restricts access to paying clients, in which case groups heading for Te ao Whekere need to take the longer route up Jordan Stream.

With our boots laced and lollies at hand, we set off at 10:30am. Matt escorted us to the farm edge where our journey into the bush began. We made quick work of the overgrown game trails, with bellbirds providing the soundtrack.

After 90 minutes of tramping, we emerged onto a 4WD track and snaked down to the luxurious and remote Shearwater Lodge. We peered through the windows at the regal appointments, admitting we'd all be fine canning the trip and spending the weekend here.

But without the cash or a key we carried on up the poled south bank of Happy Valley Stream. We crossed the river at a confluence and clambered up a bushy spur to a plateau at 1636 metres. We spotted a red stag and his harem along the way. Leo, the hunter among us, fairly foaming at the mouth.



Scramble up to Pt 1910

Our plan was to camp at the saddle below the summit. However, facing a setting sun and dropping energy levels, we opted to make a final push to 1910 metres and pitch camp there. This turned out to be an ideal and spectacular setting, with our mountain towering above and Kaikoura twinkling far below.

With our cookers struggling against the sugary snow and lower pressure of altitude, tea eventually came, then dinner, then it was into the bags at 7pm for a long night of summit dreams and cold toes.



Perfect weather for summit day



Campsite in the morning

The next morning we ditched the alpine start and rose with the sun. Continuing with our leisurely approach we left most our gear at camp and departed for the summit at 9:30am under a still blue sky. We strapped on our crampons and traversed a snowy scree slope, cutting off an unnamed peak 2109M and gaining the summit ridge. We marvelled at our luck – another day of cloudless skies and little wind.



The summit beckons

1pm was our set turnaround time. At noon, still well below the summit, we stopped for a snack and pondered the next part of the climb – a slick scramble up steep, rocky snow chutes.



Not to be denied the summit, Matt led the section with confidence. In a flash, we'd passed the steeper sections and onto the final slog, plugging holes up the snow to the false summit and indeed the proper summit at 12:59:05 – less than a minute to spare.

From the top, we took in Wellington to the north, Tappy and the Inward Kaikouras to the west, Kaikoura to the east and the snowy peaks of the Southern Alps to the south. The summit didn't come easy for all and we were damn proud to make it.



6 happy climbers on the summit

After a round of summit selfies, we retraced our footsteps back down the mountain. Dealing with the usual loose choss (defined as rock unsuitable for climbing), we returned without incident, arriving back at camp before sunset to enjoy some celebratory whisky before retiring at a geriatric 7:30pm.

Sunday morning, we broke camp and made our final descent, punctuated by rapid descent via a scree run down to Happy Valley Stream. There we enjoyed unlimited water for the first time in days, our gas depleted from melting snow. Soon after, we dipped below the treeline and coasted down to the cars, where our focus shifted from cold toes to cold beers.

This was my first trip with the alpine club, and I'm grateful for the experience. A special thanks to [Kaikoura Wilderness Experience](#) for allowing us to cross their land. Also to Leo for his good company and enduring my snoring like a gentleman. And finally to Carolyn who did a masterful job of organising what turned out to be a weekend fit for a queen.

Notices

NZAC member discounted rates at DOC huts

A reminder to members that you will need to have your ACTIVE NZAC membership card with you when paying hut fees at DOC offices to obtain discounted rates. They have no way to check your membership is active and will likely insist on seeing your card to give you member rates.

NZAC won't be able to refund overpayments, so it is important to have your member card on you at the time of payment.

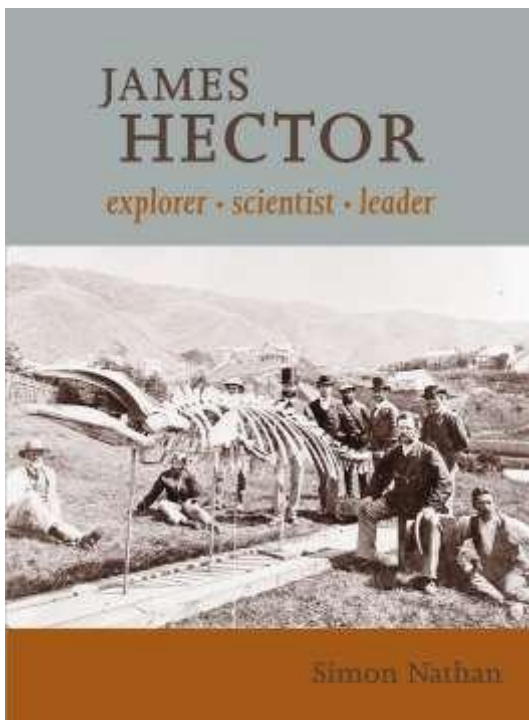
Potton and Burton - 20% discount to NZAC members

As new publications are released, specific titles will be made available to NZAC members at a 20% discount. The current offer and time limit to redeem the offer are detailed below. Information on the books' content may be found on the Potton and Burton website below.

Current Applicable title:

James Hector: explorer; scientist; leader by Simon Nathan

IISBN 9781877480461 RRP \$45.00



Discount and discount code:

20% off RRP by quoting Discount Code (viewable when logged in)
Free Freight within New Zealand

Dates available:

13 June – 30 September 2016

<http://www.pottonandburton.co.nz/store/james-hector>

Remarkable's Mixed and Ice Festival Trip - Thursday 25 to Tuesday 30 August inclusive.

Jenny Cossey (Wellington Member) is organising a private trip to the Remarkable's Mixed and Ice Festival 2016. **This is not a supported NZAC Wellington Section or National Trip.** If you would like to attend with Jenny, further details are below.

This is the annual climbing meet of the Expedition Climbers Club Incorporated. Bringing together a huge cross section of climbers from around NZ and the world. Beginners get to rub shoulders and share the rope with the top winter alpine climbers in NZ. Clinics, competitions, races and social gatherings advance and promote modern mixed climbing. Showcasing the new and existing route potential on NZ's most accessible multi-pitch winter training area, the Remarkables. Sharing local knowledge and forming new climbing partnerships. Fundraising for the ECC Expedition Capital Fund.

For more information about the festival and what options are available see more at: <http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/#!/about/>. By signing up to the festival you automatically become a member of the Expedition Climbers Club to help raise funds for NZ expeditions overseas. Festival registration is now open on a first come, first serve basis. Festival registration closes three weeks prior to the festival or whenever the clinic/general climbing allocation is full.

For more information about the trip please contact Jenny Cossey.

Please confirm your Remarkable's Mixed and Ice Festival registration and Wellington to Queenstown flight tickets to trip organiser Jenny Cossey by July 31st to confirm your attendance.

Contact Jenny on jennycossey1@gmail.com 021 072 1000

NZAC 2017 Climbing Camp

The Otago Section will be hosting the 2017 climbing camp that will be from Saturday 4th to Saturday 11th February. The Camp will be based at the Top Forks Hut in the Wilkin Valley. As it is a 12 hour walk into the Top Forks hut it is proposed that people attending the camp travel by helicopter from Makarora.

Top Forks hut is in a stunning alpine environment and there are several peaks within striking distance of the hut, many of them grade 1 climbs. Campers are expected to be self-contained with their own tent, cooking equipment, fuel and food. We will have access to the hut but not exclusive use. We will be providing some basic communal facilities such as a tarp shelter, dish-washing facilities, toilet tent, thermos and a mountain radio.

We will limit the number of people attending the camp to 40 so early registration is recommended. You can obtain additional information and a registration form from the NZAC website. There will be a modest registration fee and you are expected to pay for your helicopter or jet boat travel to and from the camp. Budget on \$170 each way to/from Top Forks for the helicopter or \$110 each way for jet boat access via Kerin Forks Hut. Note: Top Forks is still a 6 hr walk from Kerin Forks. An option is to fly in and jet boat out.

The camp is suitable for climbers of all levels of experience but you must be an Alpine club member to attend. If you do not have a climbing partner at the camp we will arrange for you to team up with other climbers.

If you require additional information contact Keith Moffat Ph 03 473-8903 Mob 0276644037 or e-mail Moffat.k172@gmail.com

Wellington Section 2016 contacts list

We are always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. If you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz

Position	Name	Contact
Chairperson	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Co Chair	Eric Duggan	021 350 161
Treasurer	Mark Leslie	027 338 4458
Secretary & Vertigo editor	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Patron	John Nankervis	
Other Committee Members	Aviette Musin	021 0299 5390
	Sharron Came	
	Gina Butson	
	Elisha Watson	
Rock Drill Overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 55 55 893

www.facebook.com/nzacwellington

Twitter @NZACWellington



Shed 6 Queens Wharf
Wellingtons Waterfront
Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896
wn@fergskayaks.co.nz
www.fergskayaks.co.nz

Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates – Retail – Rental

Alpine Club members can climb any time for \$12
Monday nights show your Alpine Club card and climb for \$10

New routes every week*

\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012

New pad in "Da Cave" allowing safe aggressive bouldering

Creating happiness through
better climbing

* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



**HangDog Rock Climbing
Adventures**

453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181
info@hangdog.co.nz

www.hangdog.co.nz

i climb
co.nz

Simond alpine equipment direct from the importer



Ocelot
\$115



MXC 820
\$230



Makalu
\$255



Caiman
\$230

all crampons include anti-balling plates
and crampon bag



i climb
co.nz